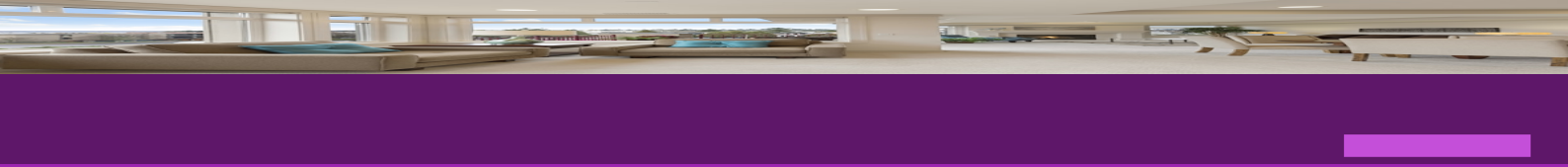


Rent an Apartment

How to Set Up Home WiFi in China: Step-by-Step Guide (2026)

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How to Set Up Home WiFi in China: Step-by-Step Guide (2026)

Unlike some countries where internet is included in the rent, in China you usually need to set up your own home broadband and WiFi. Here's a complete step-by-step guide.

First: Check if your apartment already has internet

Ask your landlord or rental agent -- is there already an active broadband line from a previous tenant? If yes, you may only need a router. If the service is cancelled, start fresh below.

Step 1 -- Choose an ISP

* China Mobile (中国移动)

* --

* 10086

* -- Largest mobile network, broadband quality varies by building.

* China Unicom (中国联通)

* --

* 10010

* -- Good for gaming and international connections.

* China Telecom (中国电信)

* --

* 10000

* -- Traditionally strongest for landline broadband, stable.

Step 2 -- Check availability

Call the hotline and ask: "I want to set up home WiFi. Is your service available in my

building? What plans do you have?" If one ISP says no, try another -- a building may only



work with one or two.

Step 3 -- Choose a plan and schedule installation

* Tell the hotline your address and choose a plan: 100 Mbps (streaming/work), 200-500

Mbps (gaming/multiple devices).

* Price: approx. ¥600-¥1500/year. Yearly payment is cheaper.

* The hotline will schedule a time for a technician to visit your apartment.

Step 4 -- Installation day: pay on the spot

The technician comes to your apartment. They bring the modem/router (光猫), set up

everything, and you pay them directly on the spot -- no need to visit a service hall

(营业厅). Payment: WeChat, Alipay, or cash. Have your passport ready (they may need to take a photo of it for registration).

Step 5 -- Setup complete



The technician connects the fibre optic port, sets up WiFi, and gives you the SSID and password. You don't need a separate router -- but you can add one later for better range.

Step 6 -- Test and keep info

Make sure all devices connect. Save your broadband account number and technician's contact. Ask for an invoice (发票) if needed.

! Tips for foreigners:

- * Hotline and technician rarely speak English -- have a Chinese friend or translation app ready.

- * Registration linked to your passport number.

- * Most plans are 12 months. Early cancellation may forfeit remaining months.

- * Moving? Call ISP to apply for "移机" (moving service) -- small fee may apply.

Useful phrases:

* 我要装宽带 -- Wǒ yào zhuān kuāndài -- I want to install broadband

* 有WiFi吗? -- Yǒu WiFi ma? -- Is there WiFi?

* 我要开发票 -- Wǒ yào kāi fāpiào -- I need an invoice

Sources: Sources: [China Mobile](https://www.10086.cn) • [China Unicom](https://www.10010.com) • [China Telecom](https://www.189.cn)

The background of the cover is a photograph of a modern, bright interior space, likely a living or dining area, with large windows on the left showing a view of a lake and buildings. The room features light-colored walls, a beige sofa, and a dining table with chairs. Overlaid on this background are several graphic elements: a large purple circle in the center, a solid purple rectangle in the top right, a solid purple rectangle in the bottom left, a solid black circle in the top left, and another solid black circle in the bottom right.

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